

A Mornington Peninsula *Autumn*

Vintage running on the ridge, warm Saturdays at the markets, the season the Peninsula is at its most editorial.

Eight pages · Six venues · One sample weekend · Updated May 2026

Autumn is the postcard.

If you have one weekend on the Peninsula, take it in autumn. The vintage is on, the cellar doors have time, the ocean is still warm enough to swim in if you must, and the produce that defines the region is at its most generous. Mornings have fog; afternoons have light angled the way photographers pretend it always does.

This guide is six venues we'd commit to in autumn, sequenced into a sample weekend that goes light on the early Saturday and heavier on the long lunch. Use it as a starting point — the live site is more current than any printed artefact.

The six

1. Tedesca Osteria

\$\$\$ · RED HILL

Brigitte Hafner's single-set-menu osteria inside a restored Red Hill farmhouse with the wood oven running all service

2. Ten Minutes by Tractor

\$\$\$\$ · MAIN RIDGE

Estate-grown pinot noir alongside a seasonal degustation rooted in the Ridge vineyard

3. Pt. Leo Estate

\$\$\$ · MERRICKS

A sculpture park walk followed by a long bay-view lunch in the glass-walled restaurant

4. Foxeys Hangout

\$\$ · RED HILL

Biodynamic Red Hill estate with an all-day deck, sunny long lunches, and a sparkling program that holds its own against French fizz

5. Paringa Estate

\$\$\$ · RED HILL

A serious single-vineyard producer with one of the Peninsula's most dependable restaurant terraces

6. Flinders Hotel

\$\$\$ · FLINDERS

A polished village-base stay with proper pub energy downstairs and Bass Strait within easy reach

A sample autumn weekend

Friday evening

Drive down. Light dinner near the hotel — the long lunch is tomorrow, save the appetite. A glass at the bar; talk to the staff about Saturday's vintage.

Saturday morning

Breakfast at the hotel or a Mornington bakery. The Red Hill or Mornington market if it's the right Saturday — check the calendar, both are worth planning a weekend around.

Saturday afternoon

The long lunch is the event. Two cellar doors before; one of the six is the second. Cabs back to the hotel by 5 — autumn light demands you finish on the deck not the road.

Sunday morning

Coast walk while the bay is calm. Coffee at a Sorrento or Flinders local. Lunch is a bowl of pasta or a counter meal — you spent the budget yesterday. Drive home with the windows down.

Peninsula Insider is independent. Every venue here was visited by the editorial desk. No paid placements. Read the Methodology at peninsulainsider.com.au/methodology.

This guide was produced May 2026. The live site supersedes; check before you book.